

Document	HR-05 Remote & Hybrid Work Policy
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Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

1. Purpose and scope

Many office roles at Tallowby Freight can be done well from home for part of the week. At the same time, a freight business depends on people who can walk across the yard, talk to a driver or sort out a problem face to face. This policy sets out how we balance the two: who can work from home, how often they need to be in the office and what support the company gives.

1.1 Who this applies to

This policy applies to employees in office-based roles at head office in Leeds and in the depot offices at Doncaster and Hull. It does not change anyone's contract. Hybrid working is an arrangement agreed between you and your manager, not a contractual right, unless your contract says otherwise.

1.2 What hybrid working means here

Hybrid working means splitting your working week between your normal office and your home in the UK. Your normal office stays your contractual place of work. Travel between home and the office is commuting, so it cannot be claimed as business travel under FIN-03, even on days when you work from home in the morning and come in later.

2. Eligibility and applying

2.1 Which roles are eligible

Hybrid working is open to office-based roles where the work can be done from home without affecting customers or colleagues. Examples include finance, customer service, HR, IT, sales and transport administration. Drivers, warehouse staff, workshop staff and shift managers are not eligible, because their work has to be done on site. You must have passed your probationary period before you apply.

2.2 How to apply

Complete form HR-HW1 in StaffPoint and send it to your line manager. Explain which days you would like to work from home, how you will stay in touch with your team and whether you have a suitable place to work. Your manager may ask for a trial period of up to 3 months before the arrangement is confirmed.

2.3 Decisions and appeals

Your manager will give you a written decision within 28 days of receiving your form. If the request is refused, the reasons will be explained. You can appeal to the Head of People within 5 working days of

the decision.

3. Time in the office

3.1 Minimum office days

Hybrid workers must spend at least 3 days a week in the office. For part-time staff this is worked out in proportion: someone working 3 days a week is expected in the office for at least 2 of them. Fully remote working is not offered, except as a short-term adjustment agreed with HR, for example during recovery from an injury.

3.2 Team days and month end

Each department sets at least one fixed team day a week when everyone is in the office. Most teams use Tuesday or Thursday. The Finance team must also be in the office on the last 2 working days of each month for month-end close. Managers can ask you to come in on extra days for training, meetings or busy periods, with at least 2 working days' notice where possible.

3.3 Booking a desk

Head office uses shared desks for hybrid staff. Book a desk in StaffPoint before you come in. Leave the desk clear at the end of the day so it is ready for the next person, and lock papers away in your locker.

4. Equipment and costs

4.1 What we provide

Hybrid workers receive a company laptop, a monitor, a keyboard, a mouse and a headset. If the workstation assessment in 6.1 shows that you need an office chair or other equipment at home, the company will provide it. All equipment remains company property, and faults should be reported to the IT Service Desk on ext. 300.

4.2 Home working allowance

When your hybrid arrangement is first confirmed, you can claim a one-off home working allowance of £150 towards setting up your workspace, for example for a desk or lamp. Claim it on form HR-HW2 in StaffPoint within 3 months of your arrangement being confirmed. It is paid through payroll. No receipts are needed, and it cannot be claimed more than once, even if you move house.

4.3 Costs we do not cover

The company does not pay for broadband, phone line, electricity, heating, printer ink or any other running costs of working from home. It does not pay for any furniture beyond what is described in 4.1 and 4.2.

4.4 Returning equipment

If you leave the company, or your hybrid arrangement ends, return all equipment to the IT Service Desk within 7 days. The IT Service Desk can arrange a courier collection if you cannot bring it in.

5. Working from abroad

5.1 How many days

You may work from outside the UK for up to 10 working days in any rolling 12-month period, for example to extend a family visit. Longer periods are not allowed, because they can create tax, legal and data protection problems for both you and the company. If you want to stay longer, the extra days must be taken as holiday.

5.2 Getting approval

Apply on form HR-HW3 at least 4 weeks before you travel. The request needs the approval of both your line manager and HR. The IT Service Desk will also check the destination, as some countries are not allowed for security reasons. Working abroad without approval is a disciplinary matter.

5.3 Rules while abroad

While abroad you must use only your company laptop, connect through the company VPN at all times and keep to your normal UK working hours. Take particular care with confidential papers and screens in public places. If your laptop is lost or stolen abroad, follow IT-O1 section 3 in the same way as in the UK.

6. Health, safety and security at home

6.1 Workstation assessment

Complete the online workstation self-assessment in StaffPoint within 2 weeks of starting hybrid working, and again if you move house or your set-up changes. The Health, Safety & Environment Manager reviews every assessment and will contact you if anything needs to be changed.

6.2 Accidents at home

If you are injured while working at home, report it in the same way as an accident at work, on form HSE-1 on the same day, following HSE-04. This helps us spot risks and makes sure any injury is properly recorded.

6.3 Confidential information

Work where other people cannot see your screen or overhear customer calls. Lock your laptop whenever you step away. Do not print customer or employee information at home. If you have work papers at home, keep them out of sight and bring them back to the office for confidential shredding.

7. Reviewing and ending an arrangement

7.1 Reviews

Your manager will review your hybrid arrangement with you at least every 12 months, and sooner if the needs of the team change or there are concerns about performance or availability.

7.2 Ending or changing an arrangement

The company can change or end a hybrid arrangement by giving you 4 weeks' written notice, with reasons. You can ask to return to full-time office working at any time by telling your manager.